

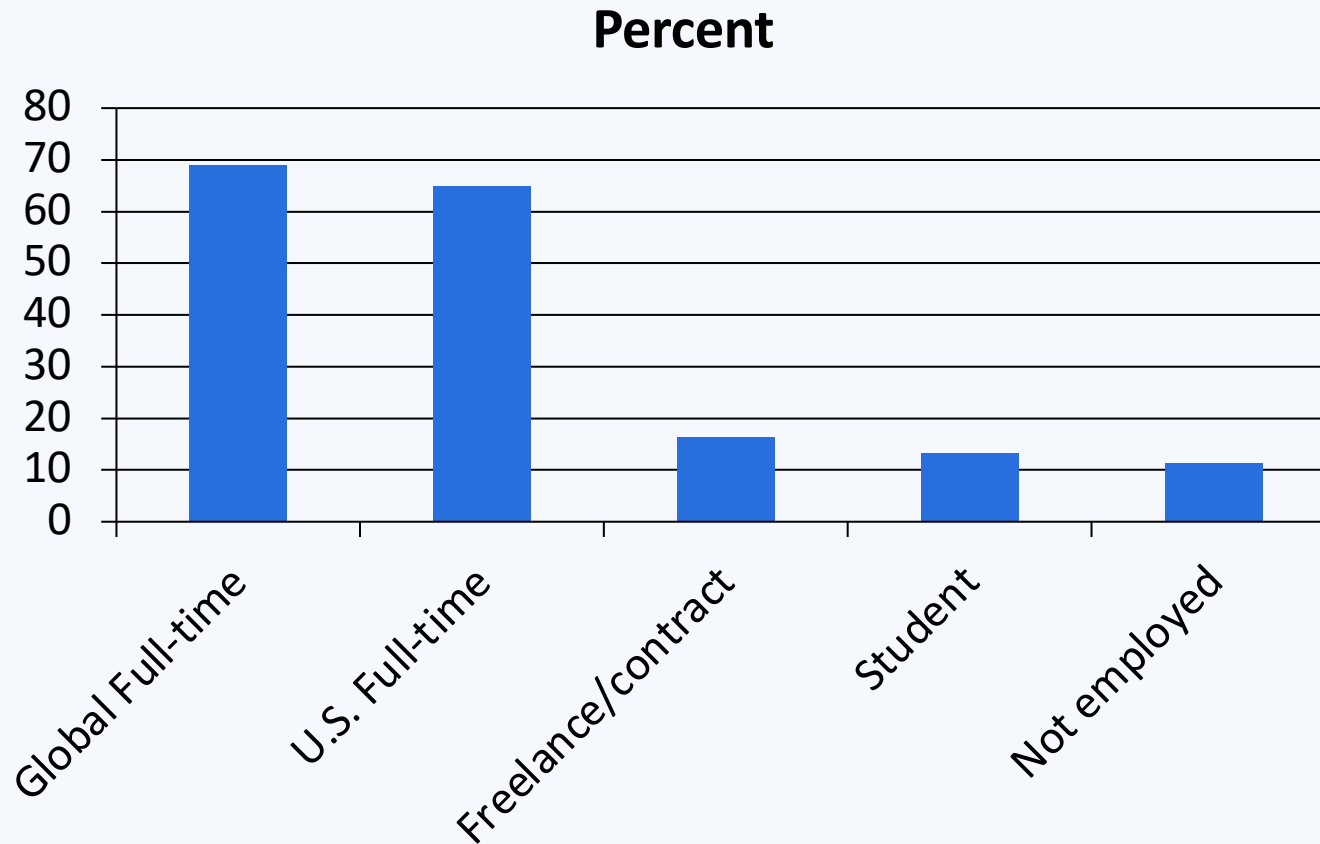
Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends — 2024 Stack Overflow

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

Key findings on employment patterns, salary by role and language, and workplace preferences.

Audience: Engineering managers and HR leaders benchmarking compensation and hiring strategy.

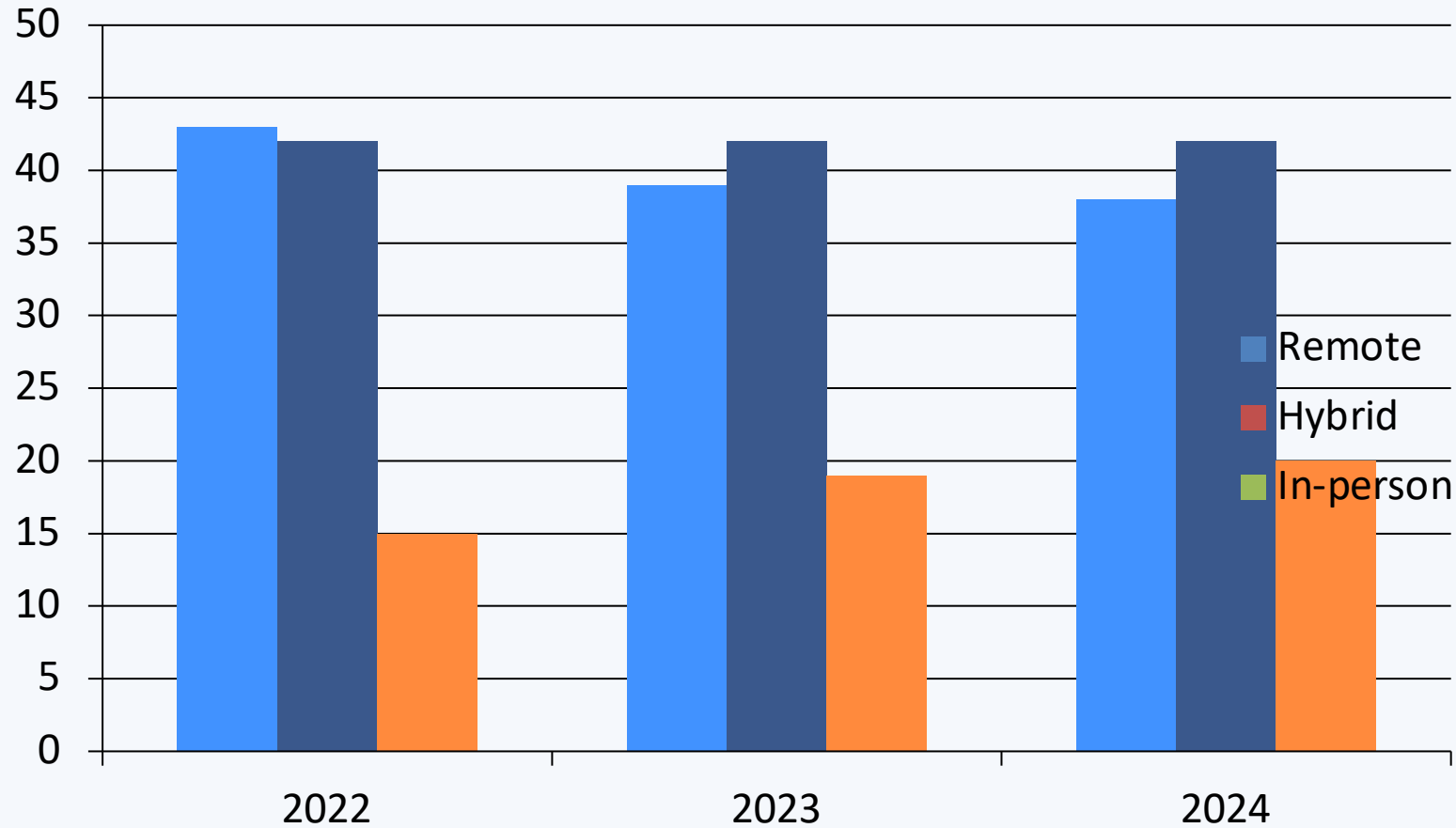
84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips



Global employment status (selected):

- Working full-time: 69%
- Freelance/contract: 16.4%
- Student: 13.2%
- Not employed (any status): 11.4%
- U.S. full-time fell from 69% (2023) to 64.8% (2024)

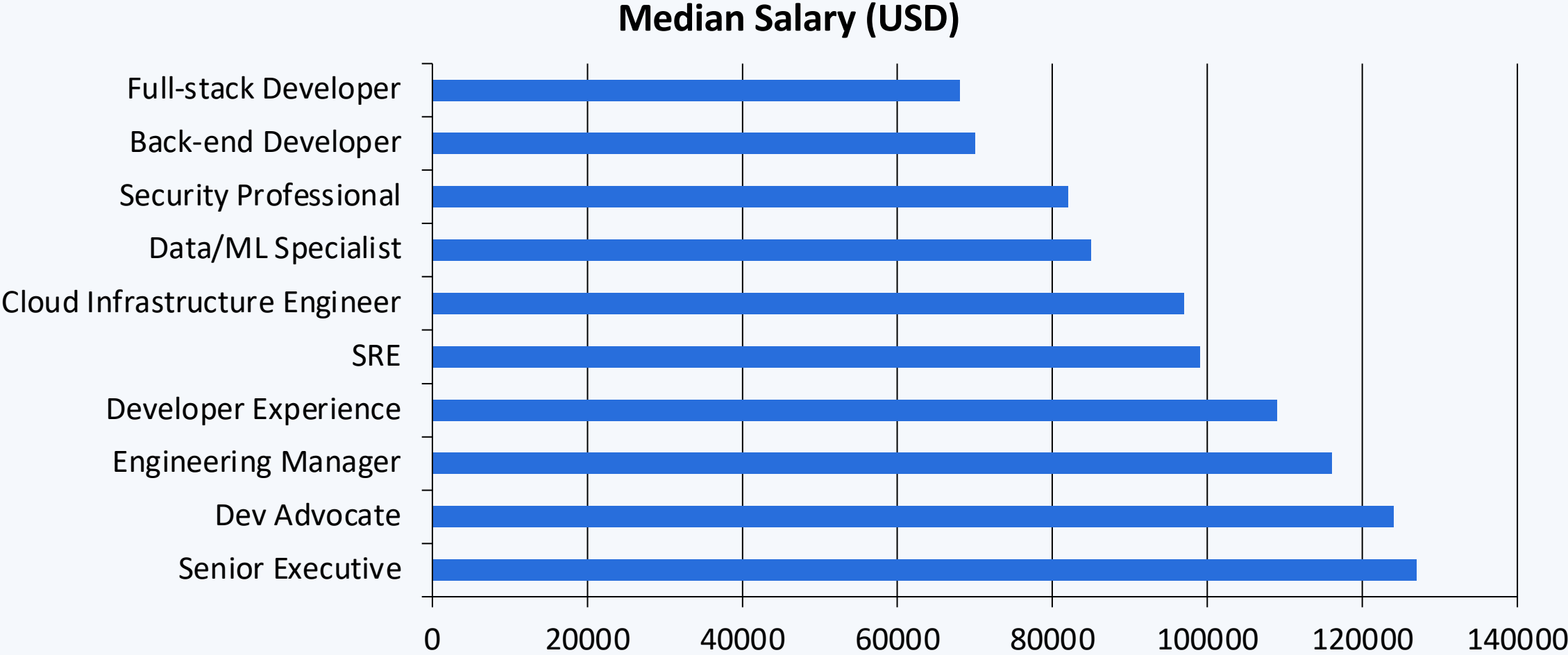
In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%



Trend signal:

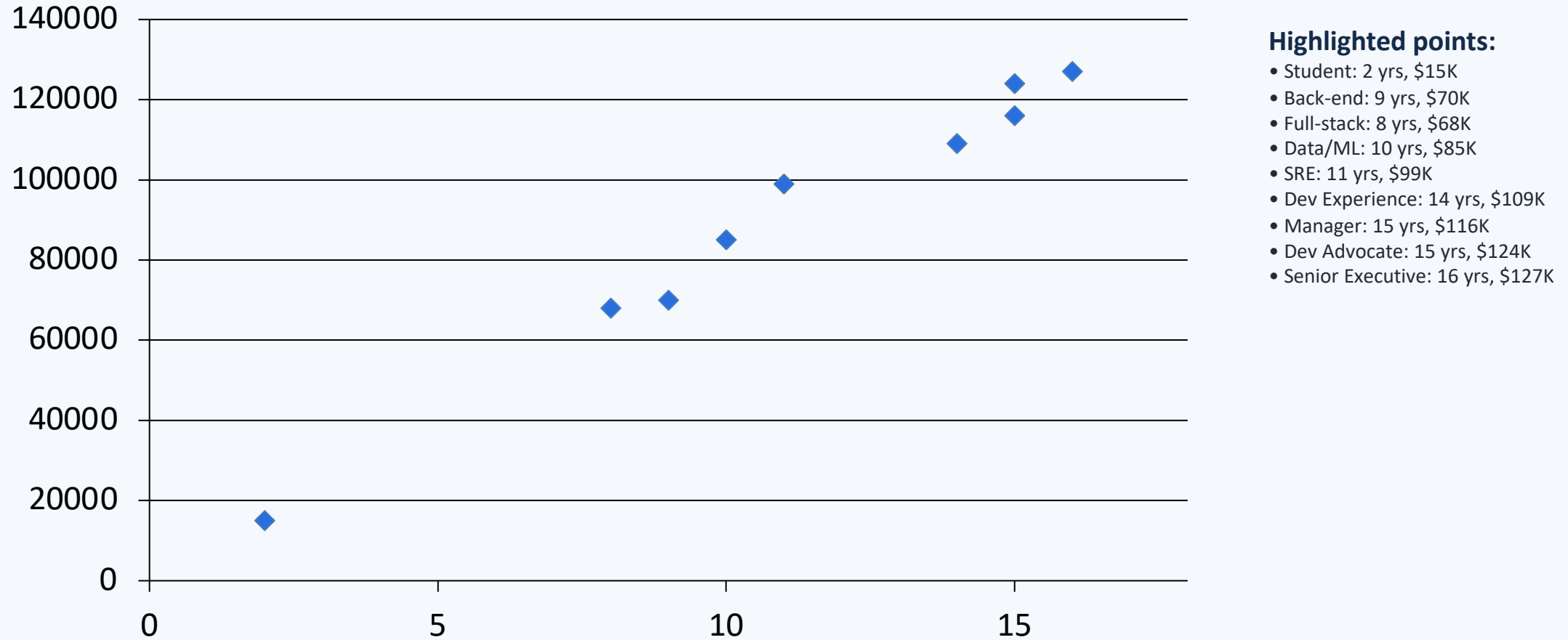
- In-person increased +5 pts since 2022
- Hybrid remained flat at 42%
- Remote declined from 43% to 38%

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

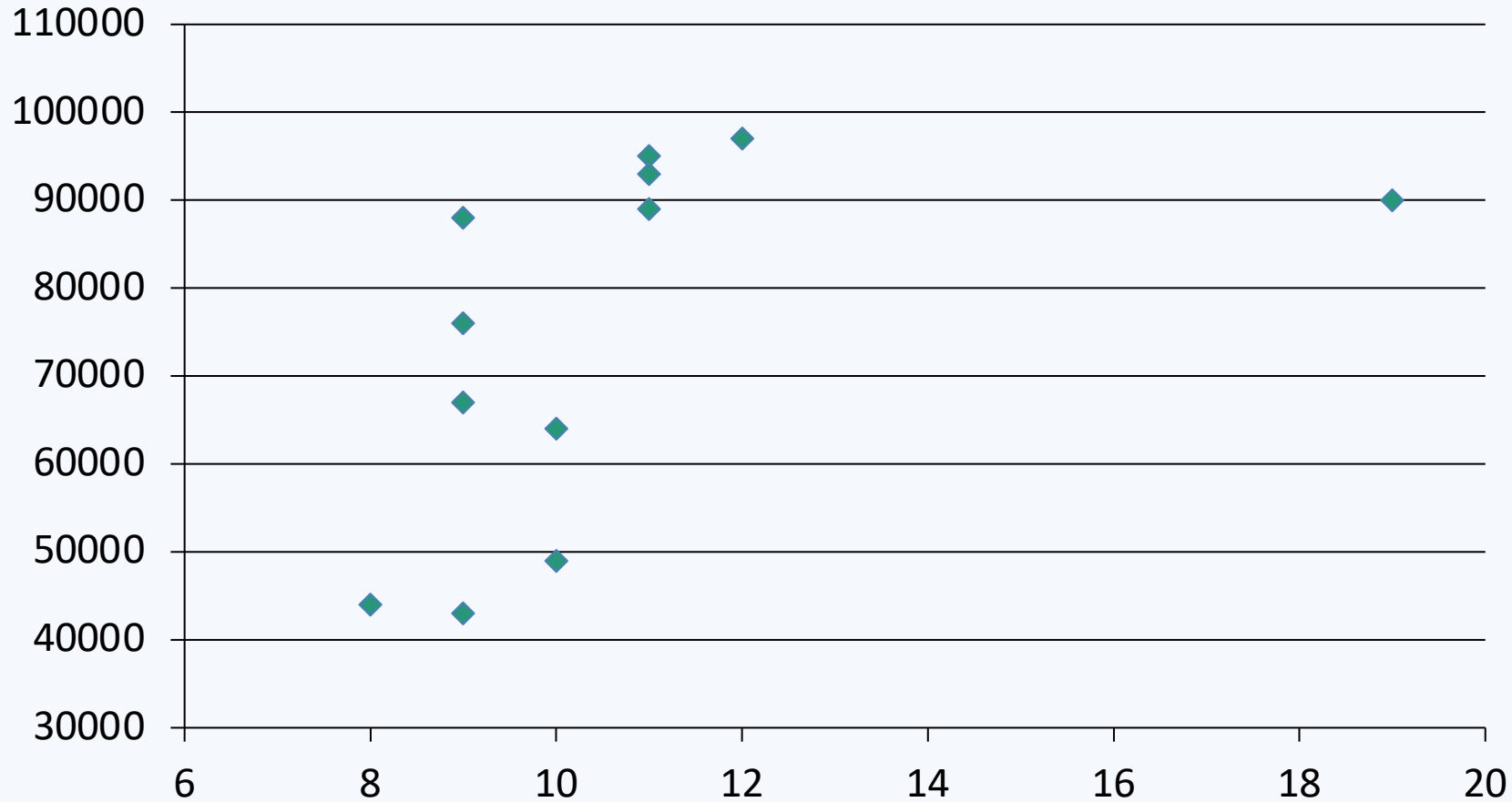


Source: Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2024

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries



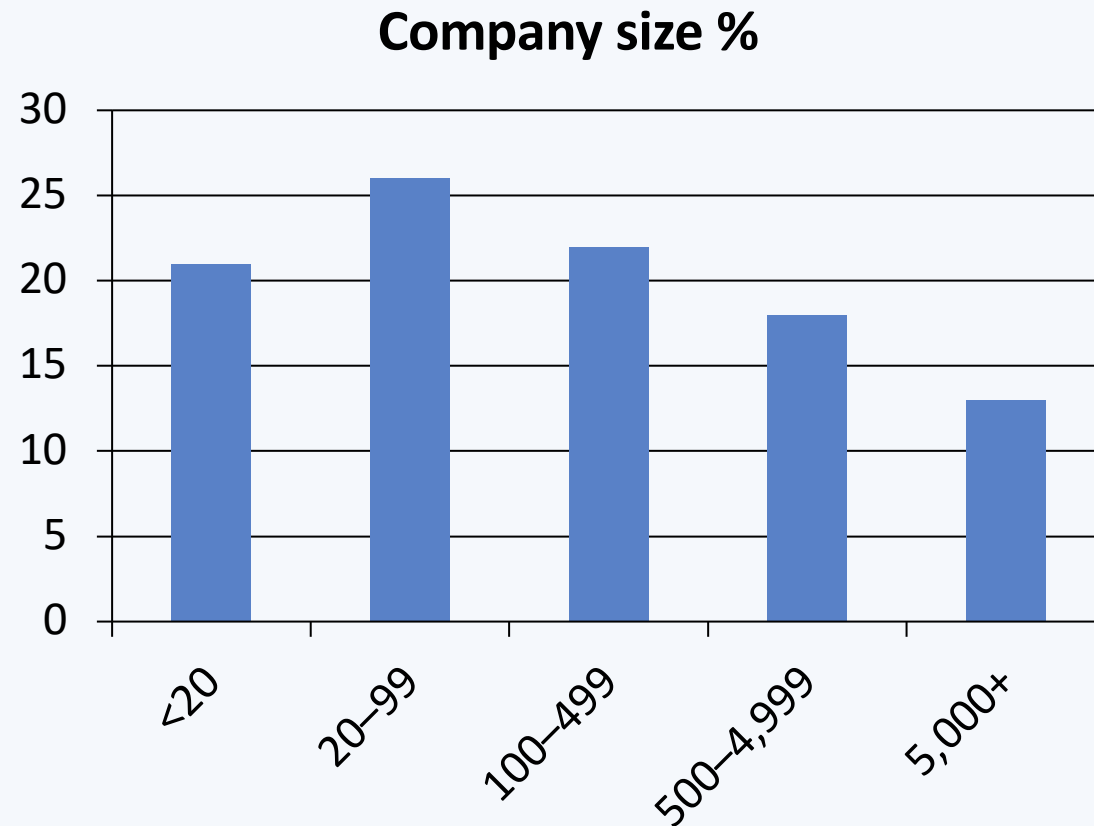
Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$40K



Language callouts:

- Top: Erlang \$97K, Clojure \$95K, Elixir \$93K
- Low: PHP \$49K, Dart \$44K, Prolog \$43K
- Reported range down ~\$10K vs 2023

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases



Technology purchasing influence

- 62% influence tech purchase decisions
- 60% prefer build-and-buy strategy
- Top influence groups: Senior executives 99%, Engineering managers 87%, Product managers 85%
- Top evaluation methods: Start free trial 75%, Ask other developers 73%

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

- Full-time employment is softening in the U.S.; maintain flexible contractor and contingent hiring plans.
- In-person mandates are rising, but hybrid remains the dominant norm at 42%—optimize policies for mixed models.
- Premium compensation clusters in leadership, DevRel, and reliability-focused roles; benchmark offers accordingly.
- Language specialization correlates with pay; niche ecosystems (Erlang/Clojure/Elixir) command materially higher salaries.
- Developers are major purchase influencers; retention and tooling strategies should address practitioner needs directly.